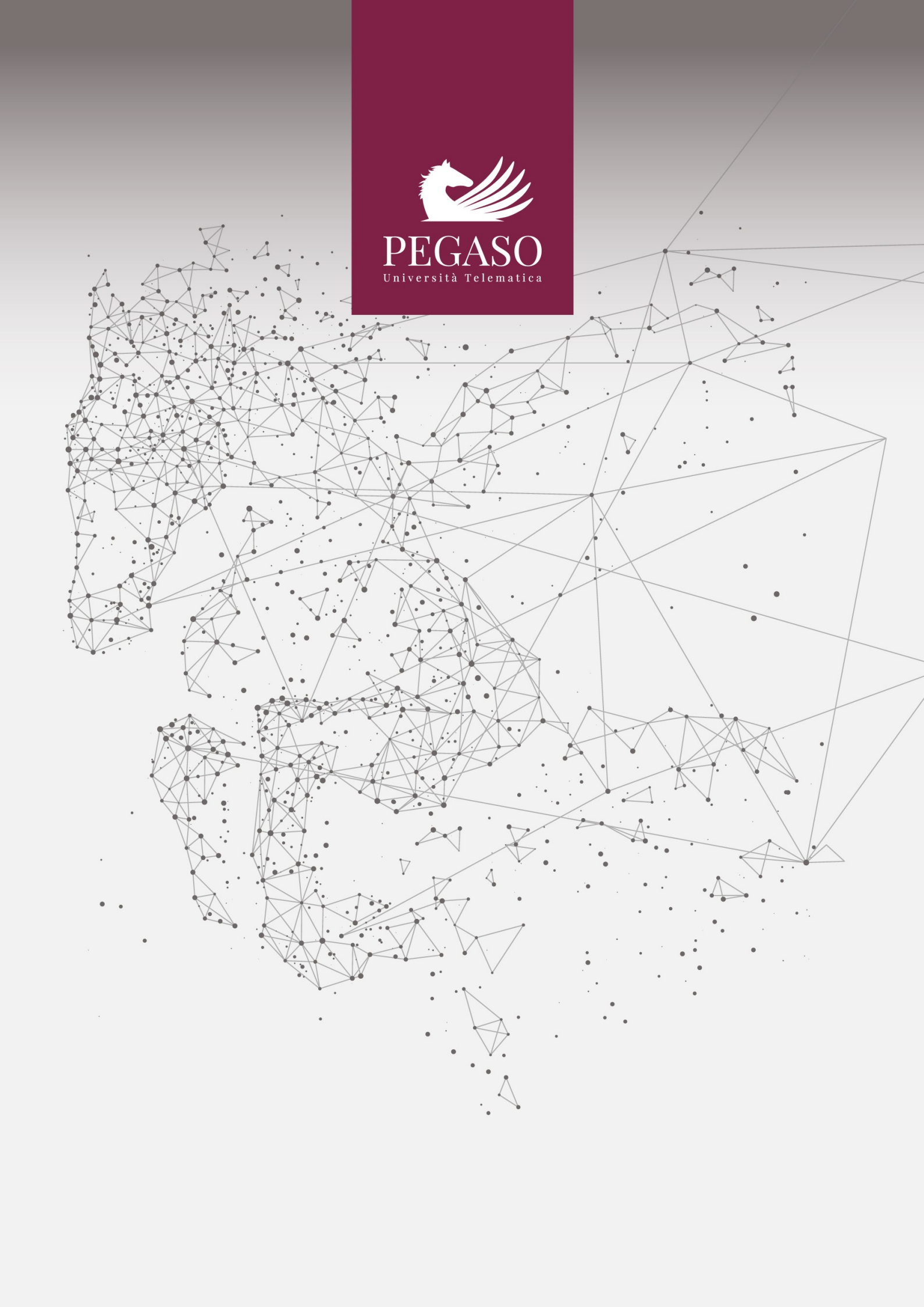

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1. Zero and first conditionals

Conditional sentences have two parts: the **if clause** and **the main clause**.

The main clause describes the result of the situation in the **IF** clause.

If you're late, we'll go without you. (we'll go…= main clause = result)

When the **IF** clause comes first, we use a comma between the two clauses. When the main clause comes before the **IF** clause, we don't add a comma between the two clauses.

If you're late, we'll go without you.

We'll go without you if you're late.

Zero Conditional

The form is: if + present simple, present simple (in the main clause)

Zero conditional is used to describe a general truth.

If there is life on other planets, we are not alone.[1]

First Conditional

We use the first conditional to talk about real possibility in the present or future and sometimes to indicate things which are generally true.

The form is usually:

If + present simple, will/won't

If I have time, I'll call you tonight. (= future possibility)

If you don't eat healthily, you won't feel good. (= generally true)

Note: that we **never use a future form in the IF clause**.

If it's a nice day tomorrow, we'll go for a picnic. (If it will be a nice day...)

We also use **when, as soon as, unless, until** and **before** to talk about the future. We always use a present tense, not a future form, after these expressions. We often use the expressions in a sentence with will.

When I finish my work, I'll get something to eat I won't eat there again unless they start using less salt.

As soon as we arrive, I'll give you a call.

[1] J. Bell and A. Thomas, *Gold First Coursebook New Edition*, Essex, Pearson Education Limited, 2014 (167)

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You won't lose weight until you improve your diet.

I'll have a shower before we go out.

As with the first conditional, we put a comma when the clause with the time expression comes first.[2]

You can also use **IF**, etc. + present continuous/ present perfect + future/imperative in the main clause to talk about possibility/likelihood in the present/future.

You won't get an interview unless you've filled in an application form.

If you're watching TV, you will see him on the news.[3]

[2] H. Stephenson, J. Hughes, P. Dummett, *Life Intermediate Student Book Second Edition*, Hampshire, National Geographic Learning, 2019 (164)
[3] J. Bell and A. Thomas, *Gold First Coursebook New Edition*, Essex, Pearson Education Limited, 2014 (167)

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2. Second Conditional

We use the second conditional to talk about unreal situations in the present or future – something contrary to present facts, or seen as unlikely to happen.

The form is: If + past simple, would + infinitive

If I liked science, I'd read more books about space exploration.

If we had to live on Mars, it wouldn't be easy.

We can also use **might** in the main clause when we are less sure about the result.

If you saw the film, you might like it.

We often use **could** in the main clause to talk about ability and possibility.

If we lived by the sea, we could go swimming every day. (= we would be able to go swimming)

When the **IF** clause comes first, we use a comma between the two clauses. When the main clause comes before the **IF** clause, we don't add a comma between the two clauses.

If we wanted to, we could do more to protect the planet.

We could do more to protect the planet if we wanted to.

We don't normally put **would** in the **IF** clause. Instead we normally use a past tense.

If I had more time, I would go travelling more often. (not If I would have more time, ...)

When we put be in the **IF** clause, we can use **were** instead of **was**. We normally do this when we use the phrase 'If I were you' to give advice.

If I were you, I wouldn't take the job.

We also use **were** in this way in other sentences. This normally sounds more formal, but some people consider it more correct.

If 1 were richer, I'd become a space tourist.

If he were more careful, he wouldn't have so many accidents.[4]

[4] H. Stephenson, J. Hughes, P. Dummett, *Life Intermediate Student Book Second Edition*, Hampshire, National Geographic Learning, 2019 (174)

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3. Third Conditional

We use the third conditional to talk about unreal situations in the past – something that could or should have happened but did not.

The form is:

If + past perfect, would + have (not) + past participle

We use a negative verb if the past event happened and a positive verb if the event didn't happen.

If you'd worked harder, you wouldn't have failed the exam. (= You didn't work hard. You failed the exam.)

If Tina hadn't helped me, I wouldn't have been able to finish the project. (= Tina helped me. I finished the project.)

When the **IF** clause comes first, we use a comma between the two clauses. When the main clause comes before the **IF** clause, we don't add a comma between the two clauses.

If you'd invited me, I'd have come to the party.

I'd have come to the party if you'd invited me.

We use the contraction **'d** in spoken English and more informal writing. It can replace either **had** or **would**.

If I'd (= had) had more time, I'd (= would) have visited the castle again.

We don't normally put **would** or **have** in the **if** clause.

We normally use the past perfect.

If those people had known the area, they wouldn't have needed a map. (If these people would have known ...)

They wouldn't have needed a map if they'd known the area. (... if they'd have known the are.)[5]

Modal Verbs in Conditionals

Modal verbs in conditional sentences

Modal verbs **can, could, might**, etc, can be used in all types of conditional sentences.

I might send him an email if I can find his address.

[5] H. Stephenson, J. Hughes, P. Dummett, *Life Intermediate Student Book Second Edition*, Hampshire, National Geographic Learning, 2019 (178)

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If she had someone to look after the children, she could go out to work.

Exercises

Match the beginnings of the sentences (1-6) with the endings (a-f). Then complete the endings of the sentences with the correct form of the verbs in brackets.

1. If she doesn't leave soon,
2. They'll have a picnic in the park next to their house
3. You can't go out
4. You'll feel sick
5. Can you call me
6. I think he'll drive to the station

a. if there _____ too much traffic. (not be)

b until you _____ all your homework. (finish)

c as soon as you _____ this message? (get)

d she _____ her bus. (miss)

e if you _____ all that chocolate! (eat)

f. unless it _____ (rain)

Complete the conversation with the correct form of these verbs.

eat

exercise

follow

not feel

not lose

lose not do

A: How are you?

B: I'm fed up! I'm trying to lose weight, but nothing's working!

A: Well, I'm sure if you (7.)_____healthy food, you (8.)_____ some weight. And you need to exercise too.

B: I try to eat healthily, but I never have time to exercise!

A: But you (9.) _____ weight if you (10.) _____ any exercise.

B: Alright! I'll go on my exercise bike before I (11.) _____to bed this evening.

A: No, that's the worst time to do exercise! If you (12.) _____ in the evening, you (13.)_____sleepy afterwards. And sleep is also important for losing weight…

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B: OK, so I'll go for a run at lunchtime instead.

A: Great. But remember - unless you (14.) _____a regular fitness program, you'll never lose weight.[6]

Match the beginnings of the sentences (15-22) with the endings (a-h).

15. ex. If I were you, **d.**

16. People wouldn't feel so stressed

17. If my sister didn't buy so many things,

18. Which sport would you do

19. If Paul didn't drink so much coffee,

20. If my parents lived closer,

21. I wouldn't have to use public transport

22. If space travel were cheaper,

a I could visit them more often.

b. she'd have more money.

c. if you had more free time?

d. I'd find another flat.

e if they didn't work so much.

f he might sleep better at night.

g. would more people try it?

h. if I had a car.

Choose the correct form to complete the sentences.

23. ex. If you ***were / would be*** a millionaire, what ***would / did*** you buy first?

24. People would ***feel / felt*** happier here if it ***were / would be*** sunnier.

25. If we ***lived / would live*** in the countryside, ***we'll / we'd*** be able to see the stars at night.

26. If I ***hadn't / didn't have*** so much work to do, ***I'd go / I went*** to bed earlier.

27. I ***can / could*** buy a new car if ***I'd save / I saved*** more money.

28. My dad ***would have /had*** more friends if ***he'd be / he was*** more friendly.

29. ***Would / Did*** you take a job for less money if it ***was / would be*** closer to home?

30. If ***I lived / I'd lived*** nearer my work, I ***could / might*** walk there.

Complete the sentences to make second conditionals.

[6] H. Stephenson, J. Hughes, P. Dummett, *Life Intermediate Student Book Second Edition*, Hampshire, National Geographic Learning, 2019 (165)

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31. I don't exercise, so I'm not very fit.

Ex. If I exercised more, I would be fitter.

32. She doesn't have his number, so she can't call him.

If she _____his number, she _____him.

33. You're tired because you don't get enough sleep.

You _____tired if you _____enough sleep.

34. He doesn't study, so he won't pass his exams.

If he _____, he _____his exams.

35. I'm ill, so I can't go to work.

If I _____ill, I _____to work.

36. She often gets headaches because she uses her computer so much.

She _____headaches so often if she _____her computer less.[7]

Read the sentences (35-39). Choose the correct option (a-b) to explain each sentence.

37. If you'd called me, I would have helped you.

a. You didn't call me.

b I helped you.

38. If I hadn't been so rude, we wouldn't have had an argument.

a We didn't have an argument.

b I was rude.

39. I wouldn't have gone to Scotland if you hadn't recommended it.

a I went to Scotland.

b You didn't recommend Scotland.

40. We would have missed our flight if we'd left when vou wanted to.

a. We didn't miss our flight.

b We left when you wanted to.

41. You wouldn't have been so cold if you'd brought a warm coat.

a. You brought a Warm coat.

b. You were cold.

Complete the sentences to make third conditionals

Use contractions where possible.

42. We didn't pay attention and we got lost we got lost.

If we _____lost.

[7] H. Stephenson, J. Hughes, P. Dummett, *Life Intermediate Student Book Second Edition*, Hampshire, National Geographic Learning, 2019 (175)

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43. We saw lots of plants when we visited the park.

If we _____ plants.

44. We didn't take more water because we didn't know now hot it was.

If we _____ more water.

45. My phone didn't work, so I couldn't call for help.

If _____for help.

46. I went to Kenya. I met my husband there.

If _____my husband.[8]

Match the pairs of sentences. Then write a new sentence using the third conditional.

47. We forgot to check our flight times.

ex. **d.** If we hadn't forgotten to check our flight times, we wouldn't have missed the plane.

48. We didn't ask anyone for information.

49. A local man gave us a map.

50. We didn't plan things very well.

51. The airline didn't let me take my bag on board.

52. We didn't get into the museum for free.

53. We didn't check the weather forecast.

a. I packed too much.

b. The holiday was a disaster.

c. We found our way to the castle.

d. We missed the plane.

e. We didn't take a phrase book.

f. We didn't take appropriate clothes.

g. We didn't have our student cards with us.[9]

Translate the following sentences into Italian.

54. If you'd waited ten minutes, you would have seen Sally.

55. Take your phone with you in case you get lost.

56. Don't call June now. If it's eight o'clock, she will be having a bath.

57. My bag always gets lost if I have a connecting flight.

[8] H. Stephenson, J. Hughes, P. Dummett, *Life Intermediate Student Book Second Edition*, Hampshire, National Geographic Learning, 2019 (179)
[9] H. Stephenson, J. Hughes, P. Dummett, *Life Intermediate Student Book Second Edition*, Hampshire, National Geographic Learning, 2019 (143)

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58. If Jack were here, I would ask him to help me with my computer.
59. Nina wouldn't have gone abroad if she had been able to find a job here.
60. You can be fined if you aren't wearing a seat belt in your car.
61. Lunch is ready now. Then, after we've eaten, we could go for a walk.

Exercise answer key

1. d. she'll miss
2. f. rains
3. b. finish
4. e. eat
5. c. get
6. a. isn't
7. eat
8. you'll lose
9. won't lose
10. don't do
11. go
12. exercise
13. won't feel
14. follow
15. d
16. e
17. b
18. c
19. f
20. a
21. h
22. g
23. were would
24. feel were
25. lived we'd
26. didn't have I'd go
27. could I saved

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28. would have he was

29. Would was

30. I lived could

31. If I exercised more, I would be fitter.

32. If she had his number, she could call him.

33. You wouldn’t be tired if you got enough sleep.

34. If he studied, he’d pass his exams.

35. If I weren’t / wasn’t ill, I could go to work.

36. She wouldn’t get headaches so often if she used her computer less.

37. a

38. b

39. a

40. a

41. b

42. If we’d paid attention, we wouldn’t have got lost.

43. If we hadn’t visited the park, we wouldn’t have seen lots of plants.

44. If we’d known how hot it was, we would have taken more water.

45. If my phone had worked, I’d / I could have called for help.

46. If I hadn’t gone to Kenya, I wouldn’t have met my husband.

47. d If we hadn't forgotten to check our flight times, / If we'd remembered to check our flight times, we wouldn't have missed the plane.

48. e We'd have asked someone for information if we'd taken a phrase book.

49. c If a local man hadn't given us a map, we wouldn't have found our way to the castle.

50 b If we'd planned things better, the holiday wouldn't have been a disaster.

51. a The airline would have let me take my bag on board if I hadn't packed too much.

52. g We'd have got into the museum for free if we'd had our student cards with us.

53. f If we'd checked the weather forecast, we'd have taken appropriate clothes.

54. Se avessi aspettato dieci minuti, avresti visto Sally.

55. Porta con te il telefono in caso (tu) ti perda.

56. Non chiamare June adesso. Se sono le otto, starà facendo il bagno.

57. La mia borsa si perde sempre se ho un volo in coincidenza.

58. Se Jack fosse qui, gli chiederei di aiutarmi con il computer.

59. Nina non sarebbe andata all'estero se fosse riuscita a trovare un lavoro qui.

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60. Si può essere multati se non si indossa la cintura di sicurezza in auto.

61. Il pranzo è pronto ormai. Dopo aver mangiato, potremmo fare una passeggiata.

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